

Ārya-Mahāmegha-vāta-maṇḍala-sarva-nāga-hṛdaya nāma mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 658 ·
Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྒྲིཨ་ཆེ་པ་རྩལ་གྱི་འཕེལ་འཕྲོལ་ལྷན་ཁྲིམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་ཉི་ཤེས་བུ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མདོ་

Toh 658 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Mahāmegha-vāta-maṇḍala-sarva-nāga-hṛdaya, in Tibetan as the Phags pa sprin chen po rlung gi dkyil 'khor gyi le'u klu thams cad kyi snying po, and in English as the Noble Great Cloud, the Chapter of the Maṇḍala of Wind, the Heart of All Nāgas. It belongs to the broader family of Great Cloud (Mahāmegha) sūtras, texts concerned with rain, nāgas, and the ritual invocation of serpent deities for the benefit of the world. The sūtra is set in a great ocean palace where the Buddha addresses an assembly of a thousand powerful nāga kings, each endowed with great miraculous power and presiding over vast maṇḍalas, situating the teaching firmly within the Mahāyāna literature devoted to nāga lore, weather, and the protection of beings through the intercession of these powerful serpentine forces.

In the language of India: Ārya-Mahāmegha-vāta-maṇḍala-sarva-nāga-hṛdaya
nāma mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Cloud, the Chapter of the Maṇḍala of Wind, the Heart of All Nāgas — a Sūtra of the Great Vehicle.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in a great ocean, in a many-storied palace with pinnacles of precious jewels, in the company of a great assembly of nāgas (nāgas) — a full thousand nāgas — every one of them possessed of great miraculous power and endowed with great maṇḍalas. They were as follows: the nāga king Joyful, the nāga king Close-to-Joy, the nāga king Truly Roused, the nāga king Garland of Lightning, the nāga king Lustrous, the nāga king Greatly Lustrous, the nāga king Upheld and Grasped, the nāga king Conch, the nāga king Cardamom Petal, the nāga king Good Boundary, the nāga king Cause of Strength, the nāga king Source of Lightning, the nāga king Bright-Crested, the nāga king Great Cloud Manifold, the nāga king Great Cloud Spreading, the nāga king Thunderer, the nāga king Rain-Producer, the nāga

king Shooting Star, the nāga king Untimely Roarer, the nāga king Thunder-Voice, the nāga king Hurler of Lightning, the nāga king Earth-Holder, the nāga king Without Grass, the nāga king Good Sight, the nāga king Fully Luminous, the nāga king Great Thunder-Roarer, the nāga king Great Shimmering Light, the nāga king Glorious Majesty, the nāga king Boundless, the nāga king Hollow Reed, the nāga king Holder of Glory, the nāga king Drum-Sound, the nāga king Voice of the Fully Resounding Drum, the nāga king Wavering, the nāga king Guide, the nāga king Glorious Throat, the nāga king Glorious Good, the nāga king Great Hissing Sound, the nāga king Tinkling Sound, the nāga king Utterly Vanquishing, the nāga king Producing Rain, the nāga king Great Wind Manifold, the nāga king Sending Forth Wind, the nāga king Steadfast, the nāga king Glorious, the nāga king Gathering Glory, the nāga king Auspicious, the nāga king Cloud-Spreading, the nāga king Gladdened by Clouds, the nāga king Of the Class that Covers with Clouds, the nāga king Well Covered, the nāga king Fully Playful, the nāga king Son of Abundant Wealth, the nāga king Unheated, the nāga king Good Radiance, the nāga king Pleasing to Behold, the nāga king Delighting in Purpose, the nāga king Well Covered by a Maṇḍala of Clouds, the nāga king Unconquerable by Others, the nāga king Drawing Water from Clouds, the nāga king Seeing Happiness, the nāga king Wind-Arising, the nāga king Wind-Stirrer, the nāga king Jewel on the Crown — and along with these great nāga kings and yet another thousand great nāga kings together.

All of them, with great nāga miraculous power and great nāga magical display, made a rumbling sound in the sky and released a great drizzling rain, and they came before the Blessed One to make request and to hear the Dharma.

Ho, great nāgas and nāgas all — come here! Mulu mulu, caṭa caṭa, paṭa paṭa, maṭa maṭa, svāhā! Send forth flashing lightning and release the great continuous downpour of a drizzling rain, and let the rain fall! Ho, ho, great nāgas — remember the truth of the buddha, the truth of the Dharma, and the truth of the Saṅgha! Ho, great nāgas — come here, come here! Let the rain fall abundantly upon Jambudvīpa! Guḍu guḍu, muḍu muḍu, hihi hihi, cuḍa cuḍa. Mahānāga hr̥daya, sarvanāganā, ākarṣaya, sañcodaya, śīghrantara, svāhā!

Let the great clouds, adorned with miraculous displays, beautiful with their fringe of every hue of precious gold, with hanging garlands of pearl ornaments — the clouds of a great ocean — and the clouds of a great ocean filled with divine palaces adorned with divine jewels, with flowers hanging in profusion — let these cover the entire expanse of the sky with their blessing. And let clouds

hang low bearing jewels, clouds of a great ocean of divine fine cloth with many threads and garlands of pearl ornaments, clouds of a great ocean resounding with sound consecrated by the blessings of the Tathāgata's profound and manifold miraculous displays, clouds of a great ocean of vast arrays of jewels that perfectly reveal inconceivable and manifold adornments of the Tathāgata's qualities — let all these cover the entire expanse of the sky with their blessing.

And let the sky be fully covered by clouds of a great ocean resounding with the sounds of great clouds of miraculous display, clouds of a great ocean sweetly ringing with the sound of divine bells made of many jewels, clouds of a great ocean where all flocks of birds cry out and a great rain of flowers pours down, clouds of a great ocean thundering greatly, with divine jewels hanging in profusion and manifold pearl pendants of every variety hanging down, clouds of a great ocean whose luminous peaks adorned with golden threads cover the entire sky, clouds of a great ocean skilled in covering the entire sky with a maṇḍala of light from garlands of many jewels, and clouds of a great ocean covering all with the great oceanic sound endowed with luminosity — let these visibly cover the sky!

Let all nāgas and all nāga kings come here! Thunder across the earth and let the rain fall! Let the rain fall abundantly! Let the rain fall everywhere abundantly! Let the sound diri riri ring out! Let the great bright lightning flash forth! Gather and assemble everywhere, rising and waving with banners aloft, pouring down — those who give forth the great voice of the nāgas, beautiful and melodious, and who resound with a great melody — let them send down rain abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa! Ghaḍa ghaḍa, ghiḍi ghiḍi, huḍu huḍu, ghuḍu ghuḍu, gaṭa gaṭa, giṭi giṭi, maṭa maṭa, caṭa caṭa, paṭa paṭa!

Ho, ho — nāgas and great nāgas, come, come, come here, come here! Dhu dhu dhu, hā hā hā hā, hī hī, hūṃ hūṃ! Thunder with a great peal of thunder, send forth a great wind — by the truth of the buddha, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

Ho, ho — nāgas and nāga kings, fully urge all nāgas on, and let the rain fall upon Jambudvīpa! Ghuḍu ghuḍu, phaṭ phaṭ, ha ha, he he! Great nāgas, assemble — let the rain fall abundantly upon the earth! Ghuḍu ghuḍu, kiri kiri, ciri ciri, miri miri, diri diri, kili kili! Let every field be filled to the full! Grain, and trees in leaf, and...

grasses, and creeping vines, and every herb — let them all spring up in abundance! Come here with a mind of loving-kindness! By the truth of the buddha, by the truth of the Dharma, by the truth of the Saṅgha, by the truth of Vajrapāṇi, and by the truth of all nāgas — great nāgas, come here, come here — svāhā!

The nāga king Dongbu is fully urged on. By the truth of the buddha, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Glorious Splendor is fully urged on. By the truth of the Dharma, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Boundless is fully urged on. By the truth of the Saṅgha, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Son of Vaiśravaṇa is fully urged on. By the truth of Vajrapāṇi, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Jogpo is fully urged on. By the truth of Brahmā, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Glorious Throat is fully urged on. By the truth of Indra, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Son of the Earth-Guardian is fully urged on. By the truth of Viṣṇu, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Garlanded One is fully urged on. By the truth of the Wrathful One, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Resplendent is fully urged on. By the truth of the sages (ṛṣis), let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Terrifier is fully urged on. By the truth of the gods, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Great Resplendent is fully urged on. By the truth of all nāgas, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Utterly Subduing is fully urged on. By the truth of the yakṣas, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

The nāga king Unheated is fully urged on. By the truth of the rākṣasas, let the rain fall abundantly upon this Jambudvīpa — svāhā!

By the truth of all the highest and most exalted nāgas, send down the rain abundantly, send down the rain! Without delay, come here, come here! Ho, ho

— great nāgas, the very heart-essence of all nāgas is fully urged on. Lead them here from every quarter! Sa ra ra — hā hā — dhu ma dhu ma — hā hā hā hā — hi hi hi hi — e hye hi — tha tha tha — ca ca ca ra ta! Let every field be filled to the full! Let the rain fall for all grain! Send forth a great wind! Drum drum — ghum ghum — pum pum — ṭa ṭa ṭa ṭa — nipāraṇi — stambhani — mohani — jāṃguli — pukkasi — prahānī — matangi — jaye vijaye — ha ha svāhā!

The Tathāgata Essence of the Great Cloud, Glorious Splendor; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Utter Conqueror; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Arising; the Tathāgata Great Cloud; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, All-Covering; the Tathāgata Who Resounds Like Great Thunder; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Expanding; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Fully Resounding Thunder, King of Sounds; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Awesome; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Protecting; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Sound of Drums; the Tathāgata Great Thunder Sound; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Glorious Splendor; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Melodious Voice; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, King of Stars; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, King of Turbulence; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, King of Great Steadiness; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Who Brings Joy by Displaying Clouds;

the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Rumbling Thunder Sound; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Who Terrifies with Terror; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, Who Sends Down Hail and Rain; the Tathāgata Cloud, King of Magical Transformations; the Tathāgata Great Cloud, For the Sake of Auspiciousness.

By the blessing of all the buddhas, and for the blessing of all bodhisattvas, the Great Cloud Tathāgata fully and correctly summons all the essences of the Great Cloud. By the truth of all nāgas, he fully and correctly summons all the essences of the nāgas. By the scriptural authority of the Three Jewels, come quickly! Hey, hey, nāgas and great nāgas, come here, come here!

Hulu hulu, suru suru, dhapa dhapa, ghara ghara, bhuru bhuru. Without delay, by the truth of the Buddha, come here. By the truth of the Dharma, come here. By the truth of the Saṅgha, come here. By the truth of all nāgas and the supreme great nāgas, one above the other, send down rain upon Jambudvīpa.

Crying "alala," they dance; crying "alala," they sing; crying "alala," they perform the great magical displays of nāgas and gather together, sending down great streams of rain. The great nāgas are teachers who display the pleasing sound of Dharma.

Gulu gulu. Nāge nāge. Caṭa caṭa. Nāganī. Hā hā hi hi. Nāge nāgi ni nāge. Sarva nāga viṣṭa mabhani māraṇi. Sarva nāga viṣṭa mabhana. Maraṇi maretaraṇi. Taraṇi. Tare. Tara tara. Tāre. Kāvilakeśi. Vikṛtadaṃṣṭri. Bhayānāge. Ākaḍḍha. Māvilampatha. Vidyujjvare. Ghorārūpiṇi. Kāle. Akāle. Garjita. Sarva megha vikurvaṇi. Sañcodani. Sarva kṣetraṇa. Apūraṇi cakra. Cakravarti. Hiri hiri. Bheghe bheghe. Smara smara. Kāli kāli. Mahākāli. Hṛdayaṃ. Praviśa aṣṭe. Matte. Sarva nāga. Ākarṣaṇi. Pūraya hūṃ hūṃ. Ratnatraya. Vikurvite. Vajriṇi. Vajre vajrapāṇi. Kālaśodhire. Nāgarūpiṇi. Surūpe. Bhogi bhogi. Mahābhogi. Bhogarūvataṇya. Vale. Varṣaṇi. Sarva nāga sañcodani svāhā. Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍa vajrapāṇaye. Bandha bandha. Surūpe. Kālarūpiṇi svāhā.

The one who teaches the Dharma shall first perform the protection rite. Then, reciting the mantra seven times into the corner of a Dharma robe and tying seven knots, one should read this chapter called "The Essence of All Nāgas of the Maṇḍala of Wind" continuously without interruption for twenty-one days.

In the east, one should draw the nāga king called the Three-Headed One, together with his retinue, in the color of ox dung. In the south, one should draw the nāga king called Abundantly Flourishing, with five heads, together with his retinue. In the west, one should draw the nāga king called Lustrous One with a Topknot, with seven heads, together with his retinue. In the north, one should draw the nāga king called Cloud-Bodied, with nine heads, together with his retinue.

The canopy, the blue cloth, the blue victory banner, and all the deity offerings shall also be blue. The invoking of the nāgas is to be done with the three sweets. Seven full oblation offerings made with the three sweets are also to be offered as fire offerings with the nāga essence mantra. Images of the cloud kings are also to be drawn and arranged touching one another, for bringing down streams of rain, with lightning flickering at the edges.

The offerings to be presented here are to be made abundantly: auspicious sprouts, sweet cakes, meat, fish, and fine foods made from honey.

Then the Dharma-speaker, being clean and dressed in clean robes, shall recite the chapter on the maṇḍala of the wind and the essence of all nāgas. From that point, beginning on the very first day, the nāgas shall make sounds reverberating from peak to peak, and pleasing sounds will arise. One must not doubt or belittle this chapter. If the ocean fails to run its course in due season, then rain, too, will fail to fall.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the King Who Proclaims the Stacked Essence of Splendor.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Drum-Sound Proclaimer.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Spreader of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Thunder Roarer.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Displayer of All Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Dripping Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Fully Expanding Cloud.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Beautiful Cloud-Limbed One.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the One Garbed in Cloud-Like Robes.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Creator of the Cloud-Thunder.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the One Bearing Garlands of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Scatterer of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Lord of Clouds.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Cloud-Holder.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Thunder-Sound.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Cloud-Bestower.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Full Proclaimer of Thunder.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Cloud-Puddle.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Cloud-Gatherer.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the Definite Thunder Roarer.

Homage to all buddhas. May all sentient beings find happiness and well-being. May all spirits be met with loving-kindness. May all those born as animals be free from fear. May all lower destinies be pacified. Homage to the one who thoroughly dispels all obscurations. May this ritual of all the Tathāgatas, this ritual beheld by all the buddhas, be accomplished.

Tadyathā: sphuṭa sphuṭa, sphuṭa sphuṭa, sphuṭa sphuṭa, sphuṭa svāhā.

When rain does not fall, a monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner — whichever one it may be — shall wash their head, put on clean robes, and with a mind endowed with loving-kindness, write these names of the Tathāgata in script, place them upon a clean seat, and

facing upward toward the sky for seven bowlfuls of space, recite the names of the Tathāgata up to fifty times, make great offerings, and do so without interruption for seven days — then rain will fall.

From the noble Great Cloud: the chapter on the maṇḍala of the wind, concerning all the nāgas —

Translator's Notes

- The name Anavatapta — the famous unheated nāga king — appears here as "the nāga king Unheated," which is the standard Tibetan rendering of that celebrated figure. Listeners familiar with the tradition will recognize him.

Several nāga king names in this passage are obscure and their Sanskrit originals are not determinable from the Tibetan alone. The renderings given are transparent translations of the Tibetan as it stands. "Hollow Reed" for རྩོམ་རྩོམ་ and "Wavering" for རྩོམ་ are tentative; these may preserve transliterated or obscure Sanskrit names whose meaning is uncertain.

- The passage is a rain-invoking dhāraṇī-text, mixing Sanskrit mantra syllables (rendered phonetically in Tibetan transliteration) with Tibetan liturgical injunctions. The mantra syllables — mulu mulu, caṭa caṭa, guḍu guḍu, mahānāga hṛdaya, sarvanāganā ākarṣaya saṅcodaya śīghrantara svāhā, and so forth — are preserved in their phonetic form as is standard for dhāraṇī passages; they are not translated. The phrase rendered "divine palaces" is literally "immeasurable palaces" (vimāna), but the context makes divine palace the clearer English expression. The sentence "those who give forth the great voice of the nāgas, beautiful and melodious" is syntactically dense and the referent somewhat fluid in the Tibetan; the rendering follows the most natural reading. The passage ends mid-sentence with an incomplete list, faithfully rendered as such.

- The nāga king names rendered here are transliterations or translations of Tibetan epithets without clear Sanskrit equivalents preserved in the text. "Dongbu," "Jogpo," and similar names are transliterated from Tibetan as proper names. "Son of Vaiśravaṇa" renders Nor rgyas kyi bu,

identifying the father as Vaiśravaṇa, the god of wealth. "The Wrathful One" for Drag po is a general epithet that may point to Rudra or Śiva in context. "Utterly Subduing" for Rab 'joms and "Terrifier" for Skrag 'bros byed are interpretive translations of epithets. The mantra syllables and dhāraṇī words in the latter portion are left as phonetic transcriptions per convention, as they resist standard translation.

- The passage contains an extended dhāraṇī sequence in transliterated Sanskrit. These mantric syllables are rendered in standard romanized Sanskrit transliteration following Tibetan phonetic spelling; some syllables are purely sonic and do not resolve into recognizable Sanskrit lexical items, which is normal for dhāraṇī literature. The Tibetan term "ཁོག་རྒྱན་" rendered as "canopy" refers to a ceremonial overhead covering; some witnesses may read this differently. The phrase "བསྐྲིད་པའི་སྤྱོད་ལྷ་མོ་བཅས་ཀྱི་ཕྱོང་ཡོད་པའི་ཆུ་ཞེས་པའི་ཚུལ་ཏུ།" refers to seven full libation or oblation pourings made with the three sweets, which in Indo-Tibetan ritual typically denotes milk, honey, and molasses or sugar.
- The string of buddha-names in this passage are epithets constructed around cloud and rain imagery, likely specific to this rain-making ritual text. Their rendering is based on straightforward compositional analysis of the Tibetan, though some (such as "Cloud-Puddle" for sprin gyi chub) may reflect ritual or archaic terminology whose precise nuance is uncertain. The mantra syllables are rendered in their Sanskrit phonetic reconstruction following the Tibetan transliteration. The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with the continuity prompt.
- The phrase "seven bowlfuls of space" renders a somewhat unusual expression; it likely indicates a spatial measure or ritual posture — sitting in the open sky with seven bowls placed facing upward. The precise ritual staging is unclear from the text alone, but the translation follows the most natural reading.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.